

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

This document defines the goals, purpose and scope of the project.

Client Name: FosterFund

Project Dates	MM - MM 2023 ▾
Document Status	Approved ▾
Product Managers	Mridhula Srinivasan
Design Managers	XXXX
Designers/Engineers	XXXX
Client Stakeholders & Roles	XXXX

Project Goals:

Design a new web app to connect verified pet sitters and fosters with animals in need and streamline the foster application process for animal rescues and prospective fosters to expand foster networks and save more rescue animals.

Who is the target user:

Primary user:

Fosters (Pet Sitters/Gig Workers/Rover Users)

- Individuals seeking flexible, short-term income opportunities by fostering dogs.
- Motivated by purpose-driven work with added compensation assurance.
- Frustrated by repetitive applications, lack of support, and inconsistent communication.

Rescues (Licensed to Pull Dogs from Shelters)

- Non-profits and independent rescues that can only save dogs when fosters are available.
- Struggling with recruitment, retention, and verification of fosters.
- Needing more scalable, efficient tools to expand their capacity and reduce euthanasia rates.

Secondary user: NGOs and donors

Why we believe it is important:

The shelter crisis has reached unprecedented levels, with over 4,000 dogs—including puppies, purebreds, and otherwise adoptable animals—euthanized daily due to lack of space. Rescue dogs face urgent, life-threatening challenges, with many at risk of euthanasia or extended stays in overcrowded shelters. The greatest barrier to saving these animals is the scarcity of reliable, pre-approved fosters willing and able to provide temporary care.

Compounding this issue, current foster processes are fragmented. Prospective fosters need to repeatedly navigate separate applications simultaneously across multiple rescues, while organizations grapple with limited resources to recruit, vet, and manage fosters efficiently. This disconnect results in fewer dogs finding temporary homes and slows the overall rescue pipeline.

FosterFund's mission is to raise awareness and rapidly expand the foster network by making fostering more accessible and financially supported. For fosters and pet sitters, the platform simplifies the process with a single universal application and smart matching tailored to individual lifestyles and availability. By broadening the digital foster community, FosterFund has the potential to save millions of dogs from euthanasia and transform the animal rescue ecosystem.

Background:

FosterFund's Canine Compatibility Matcher (FCCM) is a digital platform designed to revolutionize the foster-based pet adoption ecosystem. It connects verified, pre-approved pet sitters and fosters with rescue dogs in need of temporary care, offering the added benefit of guaranteed compensation for fosters. Central to the platform is a universal foster application that allows users to apply once and gain access to a wide network of dogs across multiple rescues. Since rescues can only save dogs if they have committed fosters, this website will provide them with an entirely new pool of pre-approved fosters, enabling them to rescue more animals than ever before.

Currently, FCCM is in the pre-MVP stage, with conceptual development and prototyping underway. A placeholder website currently exists, and a foundational network of fosters and rescues has already been established. The development of FCCM will follow a three-phase launch plan, beginning with an MVP that delivers core functionality. The platform will be designed with scalability and flexibility in mind to allow seamless integration of back-end and AI-powered features in future phase.

Functional requirements by priority:

#	Requirement	User Story As a [user role], I want to [activity], so that [desired business value].	Acceptance Criteria: Informs technical design (functional capability, measurable criteria such as response rate, or other outcome)	Priority (MoSCoW)	Effort (H, M, L)
1	Foster sign-up	As a potential foster, I want to create a profile so that I	- User is required to fill out all mandatory fields (name, email, password,	M	M

		can browse and save dog profiles.	location) - A confirmation message ("Account successfully created") is displayed upon completion - Once signed up, the user is redirected to the Request Form		
2	FosterFund Request form	As a potential foster, I want to fill out an application once, so that I can spend less time on paperwork to express interest in fostering a dog.	- Required fields from FosterFund form are captured - Autosaved to profile	M -	H
3	Submit a request	As a user, I want to be able to apply to foster a specific dog so that I can express my interest directly from the dog's profile.	- Each dog profile includes a clearly visible "Apply" or "Submit Request" button. - Clicking the button opens a request form that is automatically linked to the specific dog's profile - Upon successful submission, a confirmation message is displayed	M -	M
4	Dog listing (browse dog)	As a potential foster, I want to see all listed dogs so that I can easily browse and save dog profiles.	- A list of available dog profiles is displayed, each showing key information (e.g., name, breed, age, location, and a photo). - A search bar is available at the top of the listing page.	M -	H
5	Dog Profile Details	As a potential foster, I want to click into a dog's profile to view detailed information, so that I can make a decision about fostering.	- All fields (name, breed, size, picture, fun fact) are listed - The user can easily return to the dog listing page via a "Back" button or browser navigation.	M -	M
6	Design System (Style Guide) <i>Technical Requirement</i>	As a rescue organization, I want FosterFund to have a strong and consistent branding and design system, so that I feel confident and professional partnering with them.	- Style Guide: including typography, colour palettes, spacing, and iconography - Documentation - guidelines on how to implement the design system	S -	H
7	Design System (Reusable Components) <i>Technical Requirement</i>	As a rescue organization, I want FosterFund to have a strong and consistent branding and design system, so that I feel confident and professional partnering with them.	- Reusable Components: buttons and navigation bars	S -	H
8	Uploading Dog Profile	As a rescue organization user, I want access to a dog profile submission form so I	- A screen with a button linked to the Google Form - A submission form (Google Form for	C -	M

		can easily add new dogs for fostering.	MVP) is accessible via the rescue portal or link.		
9	Dog Profile Submission Form Fields	As a rescue user, I want the form to collect all relevant dog information (name, age, breed, size) so that fosters can get complete profiles.	- Form includes required fields: dog name, age, breed, size, and other relevant details.	C -	L
10	Submission Confirmation Notification	As a rescue user, I want to receive a confirmation email after submitting a dog profile so I know the upload was successful.	- Confirmation email or message is sent automatically after form submission.	C -	L

UX Design:

Goals:

- Develop a Design System consisting of reusable components, style guides, and clear documentation.
- Develop a high-fidelity interactive Figma prototype aligned with the aforementioned Design System and FosterFund branding.

Key Deliverables:

- Design System
- Foster Registration Flow & Limited Functionality for Rescue Registration flow (see Requirements)
- Prototypes that follow FosterFund's branding and design system

Engineering Notes:

The focus of this project is on **low/no-code web design and detailed wireframe mockups**. While our team will prioritize designing within engineering parameters to ensure smooth integration, implementation and technical development are outside the scope.

Scope of Our Team

Our team will be responsible for the following deliverables:

- Deliver a design system that aligns with FosterFund's branding, including typography, color palette, UI components, and usage guidelines.
- Deliver accessible mockups and wireframes

Out of Scope

- Backend Development
- Frontend Development
- Deployment or Release

Test Plan / Supported environment:

The MVP will be developed and tested primarily for web platforms, including desktop and mobile web versions. The web application will be mobile-responsive, ensuring compatibility with mobile web browsers.

Testing Strategy:

- **Usability Testing:** User testing with a sample of users from our target user group on Figma prototypes at both the mid-fidelity and high-fidelity stages to determine the design's usability and accessibility.
 - **Focus:** clarity of navigation, ease, task completion rates.
- **Accessibility Testing:** Ensuring that the design system and the style guide components all follow the WCAG guidelines.
- **Error Handling:** ensuring that errors (e.g. invalid inputs, inability to submit forms) are clearly communicated to the user with clear and concise messaging.

[Platform, browser, mobile support for development and testing.]

Platforms:

- Web (Responsive design - Desktop, Tablet, and Mobile breakpoints)

Testing Focus Areas:

- Core user flows (Foster & Dog Profile System, Matching System & Application Process, Communication & Notifications)
- Accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA)

Design and Research Tools:

- All user interface designs will be created using Figma as the primary design tool. For user research, documentation, and usability testing, Notion and Miro will be used.

Functionality & Testing:

- Assess the user experience of the interface through user interviews and usability testing, identifying areas for improvement in navigation, task completion, and overall user satisfaction.
- End-to-end testing of user flows (e.g., sign-up → save dog)
- Usability testing with 2–3 real fosters or rescue partners]

Key Performance Indicators:

Short-term KPI:

- 1) Usability Testing
 - Qualitative feedback from testing Figma prototypes with fosters and rescue admins.
 - User Error Rate - Measures the percentage of errors that a user may make while completing task flow. The lower the percentage, the better the user experience is.
 - Task Success Rate - Measures percentage of users who are able to complete the task flow.

Long-term KPI:

Measurable result (e.g. Number of donations submitted through website, number of users)

- 1) Number of Pre-Approved Fosters Registered - Tracks the growth of the foster network and measures platform adoption by individuals willing to foster dogs.
- 2) Number of Successful Foster Matches Facilitated - Measures the platform's effectiveness in connecting rescues with suitable fosters and its overall impact on saving animals.
- 3) Application Completion Rate - % of users who successfully submit the universal foster application

Stretch goals:

- Searchable Directory: searching and filtering for different dog profiles based on their descriptions/tags.
- Application Status Notifications: Sending updates to users regarding their application status (approved, denied, pending).

Out of Scope:

List feature requests that are out of scope for this project.

- Features
 - Push or in-app notification systems
 - Matching System: Any form of user or content matching
 - Reminders for upcoming foster dates, profile updates, or required actions.
 - Real-Time Alerts and Messaging between users and administrators (in-app chat or alert)
- Backend Development: No server-side logic, APIs, or database integration will be implemented.
- Frontend Development: Work will be limited to wireframes; no interactive or production-ready front-end components will be developed.
- Tool Deployment and Release: The final product will not be packaged, deployed, or released to end users.